Northwind Labs Employee Handbook

Version 4.2 | Effective January 1, 2026

1. Welcome & Workplace Principles

Welcome to Northwind Labs! We are committed to fostering a collaborative, ethical, and inclusive environment. Employment at Northwind Labs is at-will, meaning either you or Northwind Labs may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause or prior notice. All workplace decisions adhere to equal employment opportunity principles.

2. Onboarding & 90-Day Probationary Period

All new hires undergo an initial 90-calendar-day probationary period. During this period, performance and cultural fit are reviewed at 30, 60, and 90-day intervals with your manager. Satisfactory completion of the 90-day probationary period confirms regular full-time status and activates full eligibility for tuition assistance.

3. Working Hours & Core Collaboration Hours

Northwind Labs maintains standard 40-hour workweeks for full-time employees. All full-time employees are required to be accessible and available during core collaborative hours from 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM EST, Monday through Friday. Flexible start times between 7:30 AM and 10:00 AM EST are permitted with prior team manager approval.

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4. Remote Work & Hybrid Telecommuting Policy

Employees in eligible hybrid roles may work remotely up to 2 days per week, coordinated directly with their department lead (customarily scheduled on Tuesdays and Thursdays). Remote employees must maintain a dedicated private workspace and an internet connection with a verified minimum download speed of 50 Mbps. Company laptops must remain within the continental United States unless formal international travel clearance has been authorized by IT and HR.

5. Paid Time Off (PTO) & Vacation Accrual

Northwind Labs values work-life balance and provides generous paid vacation for full-time staff. New employees accrue 18 days of paid vacation per year, calculated at a rate of 1.5 days per month of active service. Annual vacation accrual increases to 22 days per year upon completing 3 years of continuous service, and 25 days per year after 5 years. Vacation requests exceeding 3 consecutive days must be submitted through BambooHR at least 2 weeks in advance. A maximum of 5 unused vacation days may be rolled over into the subsequent calendar year; any excess unused days expire on December 31.

6. Company Paid Holidays

Northwind Labs observes 11 paid company holidays each calendar year, including New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Jr. Day, Memorial Day, Juneteenth, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day, the day following Thanksgiving, Christmas Eve, Christmas Day, and one floating cultural holiday of employee choice.

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7. Paid Sick Leave Policy

All full-time employees receive 10 paid sick days per year, credited upfront on January 1 of each calendar year. Sick leave may be utilized for personal physical or mental illness, medical appointments, or to care for an immediate family member. Unused sick days do not roll over from year to year and are not paid out upon separation of employment. Consecutive sick leave absences exceeding 3 business days require documentation from a licensed healthcare provider.

8. Parental Leave Policy

Northwind Labs provides 12 weeks of fully paid parental leave for primary caregivers following the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child. Secondary caregivers are entitled to 6 weeks of fully paid parental leave. To qualify, employees must have completed a minimum of 6 months of continuous full-time service prior to the qualifying event. Parental leave must be taken within the first 12 months of the child's arrival and may be taken continuously or in two separate blocks.

9. Medical & Family Leave (FMLA)

Employees with at least 12 months of service who have worked at least 1,250 hours during the previous 12 months are eligible for up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave under the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA) for qualifying family and medical emergencies.

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10. Bereavement Leave

Employees are eligible for up to 5 consecutive paid business days for the death of an immediate family member (spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, or sibling). Up to 3 consecutive paid business days are granted for the death of extended family members (grandparent, grandchild, aunt, uncle, or cousin). Additional unpaid leave may be granted upon request to HR.

11. Jury Duty & Civic Obligations

Northwind Labs provides up to 2 weeks (10 business days) of fully paid leave for employees summoned to jury duty service. Employees must provide a copy of the official court summons to HR within 48 hours of receipt. Employees are also granted up to 2 hours of paid time off to vote in local, state, or federal elections if polls are not open for 2 consecutive hours outside their normal work shift.

12. Voluntary Resignation & Notice Period

To ensure continuity of operations, non-exempt hourly employees are requested to provide a minimum of 2 weeks written notice prior to resignation. Exempt professional, managerial, and executive employees are expected to provide 4 weeks written notice. Final paychecks, including accrued unused vacation pay (subject to rollover limits), are disbursed in accordance with state statutory requirements.